The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

11th February 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Exorbitant (अत्यधिक /अत्यावश्यक से अधिक)

Meaning: Unreasonably high or excessive.
Synonyms: Outrageous, excessive, astronomical
Antonyms: Reasonable, moderate, fair
Example: The exorbitant property prices in urban areas make housing unaffordable for many.

2. Impunity (दंडमुक्ति)

Meaning: Exemption from punishment or freedom from the consequences of an action.
Synonyms: Immunity, exemption, freedom
Antonyms: Accountability, liability, punishment
Example: Many corrupt officials act with impunity, knowing they will not be punished.

VOCABULARY

3. Renege (इनकार करना)

Meaning: To go back on a promise, undertaking, or contract.
Synonyms: Break, default, backtrack
Antonyms: Fulfill, honor, adhere
Example: The company reneged on its agreement to provide free healthcare for employees.

4. Deplorable (शर्मनाक/दुर्दशाजनक)

Meaning: Shockingly bad in quality.
Synonyms: Appalling, disgraceful, abysmal
Antonyms: Admirable, commendable, acceptable
Example: The deplorable state of urban infrastructure hinders economic progress.

VOCABULARY

5. Insurmountable (अजेय/अपराजेय)

Meaning: Too great to overcome.
Synonyms: Unconquerable, overwhelming, undefeatable
Antonyms: Achievable, surmountable, possible
Example: The challenges in urban planning may seem insurmountable, but they can be addressed with the right strategies.

6. Exacerbate (बिगाड़ना /गंभीर बनाना)

Meaning: To make a problem worse.
Synonyms: Aggravate, worsen, intensify
Antonyms: Alleviate, mitigate, improve
Example: Poor governance has only exacerbated the crisis in urban development.

VOCABULARY

7. Impediment (रुकावट/बाधा)

Meaning: Something that slows down or prevents progress.
Synonyms: Hindrance, obstruction, hurdle
Antonyms: Facilitator, aid, advantage
Example: Lack of funding is a major impediment to sustainable urban development.

8. Unprecedented (अभूतपूर्व/बेमिसाल)

Meaning: Never done or known before.
Synonyms: Unparalleled, extraordinary, unique
Antonyms: Common, ordinary, routine
Example: The budget was introduced at a time of unprecedented global uncertainty.

VOCABULARY

9. Utterance (कथन)

Meaning: A spoken word, statement, or vocal sound.
Synonyms: Remark, expression, declaration
Example: His utterance of the phrase "I'm sorry" was barely audible.

10. Ruinous (विनाशकारी)

Meaning: Involving or causing sudden great damage or suffering.
Synonyms: Disastrous, calamitous
Antonyms: Fortunate, favorable, harmless
Example: The company's ruinous decision to expand too quickly led to bankruptcy.

VOCABULARY

One-word substitute

1. A person who is selflessly concerned for the well-being of others:
Altruist

2. Having a great appetite or eagerness for something, especially food or knowledge:
Voracious

3. Having unlimited power or authority:
Omnipotent

4. The inability to sleep:
Insomnia

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Chew out
Meaning: reprimand someone severely

2. Cling to
Meaning: to hold on tightly to somebody/something

3. Count on
Meaning: rely on someone or something

4. Gin up
Meaning: generate or increase something, especially by dubious or dishonest means

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Haste makes waste

Meaning: rushing through something can lead to mistakes or poor results

2. Get wind of something

Meaning: hear news of something secret

3. Shape up or ship out

Meaning: work better or leave

VOCABULARY

4. Dog days of summer

Meaning: the hottest day of the summer season

5. Bits and Pieces

Meaning: small things of different types

Article for Reading

Troubled waters: On India, Sri Lanka and the fisheries dispute

In the latest chapter of the long-standing fisheries dispute in the Palk Bay region, the Sri Lankan Navy arrested 14 fishermen from Tamil Nadu's Ramanathapuram district on February 8 for alleged poaching in waters north of Mannar. Two trawlers were also impounded. On January 27, the Navy fired at an Indian boat near Delft Island, injuring two fishermen. With these arrests, the total number of Indian fishermen detained this year has risen to 77. Just last week, a Sri Lankan court released nine fishermen from Karaikal, Puducherry, but one other person received a six-month prison sentence. Additionally, Sri Lankan courts have been imposing hefty fines, complicating their release. Government data over the past decade, based on responses in Parliament, show that in 2024, the number of Indian fishermen arrested in Sri Lanka crossed the 500-mark for the first time in 10 years (528). There were 787 arrests in 2014.

In a letter to External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar on February 3, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.K. Stalin said that 97 fishermen and 216 fishing boats were still under the custody of Sri Lanka. Unlike in the past, when they were quickly released, recent years have seen rising convictions for violations of the International Maritime Boundary Line (IMBL) and unlawful fishing. While Tamil Nadu and Puducherry fishermen often cross the IMBL, their counterparts in Sri Lanka's Tamil-speaking Northern Province, who are still recovering from the civil war, oppose their fishing methods, particularly ecologically destructive bottom trawling. Northern Sri Lankan fishermen are seeking a sustainable solution that protects their waters from over-exploitative fishing. Indian fishermen have repeatedly sought a fresh round of talks with their Sri Lankan counterparts, with the last such meeting having taken place in November 2016. The issue was also raised in the most recent Joint Working Group meeting in Colombo last October.

However, the Anura Kumara Dissanayake-led Sri Lankan government appears reluctant to negotiate. New Delhi and Colombo must recognise that a fresh approach is required to break the deadlock rather than continuing with a business-as-usual mindset. Unlike the cases of Indian fishermen detained in Pakistan, Bangladesh, Saudi Arabia, and Qatar, the arrests in Sri Lanka are significantly higher. New Delhi must introduce incentives to encourage Palk Bay fishermen to move away from trawling. While this shift will take time, both governments must facilitate immediate discussions between their fishing communities to find interim solutions. It is only through proactive diplomacy and sustainable fishing policies that this ongoing conflict can be addressed effectively.

Summary

The passage discusses the ongoing fisheries dispute in the Palk Bay region, where the Sri Lankan Navy recently arrested 14 Indian fishermen from Tamil Nadu for alleged poaching. With these arrests, the total number of Indian fishermen detained in Sri Lanka this year has risen to 77. Sri Lankan authorities have been imposing stricter penalties, including hefty fines and imprisonment, in contrast to past quick releases. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.K. Stalin has urged India's External Affairs Minister to take action, as nearly 97 fishermen and 216 boats remain under Sri Lanka's custody. The conflict stems from Indian fishermen crossing the International Maritime Boundary Line (IMBL) and using bottom trawling, a method strongly opposed by Sri Lankan Tamil fishermen for its environmental damage. While Indian fishermen have sought renewed negotiations, the Sri Lankan government has shown reluctance. The article calls for a fresh diplomatic approach, advocating incentives for Indian fishermen to transition away from trawling and urging both governments to facilitate discussions for sustainable fishing solutions.

Tone:

The tone of the passage is serious, concerned, and diplomatic. It highlights the persistent tensions in the Palk Bay region, the plight of Indian fishermen, and the necessity for urgent intervention through dialogue and sustainable solutions.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
According to the passage, what key measure does the author suggest to resolve the fisheries dispute?

a) Increase naval patrolling in the Palk Bay region to prevent boundary violations.
b) Offer financial incentives to Indian fishermen to transition away from trawling.
c) Impose harsher penalties on Indian fishermen to discourage illegal fishing.
d) Request international organizations to mediate between India and Sri Lanka.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
Why does the author suggest that a fresh diplomatic approach is needed to resolve the conflict?

a) Past negotiations have failed, and Sri Lanka seems unwilling to engage in talks.
b) The Sri Lankan Navy has become more aggressive, making diplomacy ineffective.
c) The Indian government has stopped addressing the issue diplomatically.
d) India is focusing on bilateral trade relations rather than the fisheries dispute.
e) None of the above

Question 3:
How has Sri Lanka's response to Indian fishermen’s violations changed in recent years?

a) Sri Lanka now confiscates boats permanently rather than imposing fines.
b) The Sri Lankan government has become more lenient, releasing fishermen quickly.
c) Sri Lanka has started imprisoning Indian fishermen for life for violating maritime boundaries.
d) Sri Lanka has increased convictions and fines, making releases more difficult.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

Budget 2025-26: A promising first step, but many miles to go

The Union Budget unveiled on February 1, 2025, has come at a timse of unprecedented global uncertainty and a flagging domestic economy. The real GDP growth is estimated at 6.4% for 2024-25 and between 6.3-6.8% for 2025-26, a far cry from greater than 8% growth required annually to make India a developed nation by 2047. While much attention has been devoted to the demand stimulus through income tax cuts, not enough is said about the proposed reforms in urban development, tariff rationalisation, and regulatory simplification aimed at making Indian cities and corporates more competitive. Since the majority of economic activity is located in cities (urban areas account for ~55% of GDP) and produced by large corporates (~40% of the national output and 55% of India's exports), the above-mentioned reforms have a pivotal role in improving India's trend growth rate. We unpack each reform.

The government has identified “urban development” as one of the key growth pillars. World over, urbanisation and economic growth go hand in hand, and India is no exception. What makes prioritising cities important now is that the urban share of GDP has remained stagnant between 52-55% from 2000-2020. Given that the urban share of the population has continued to increase during this period, this implies that per capita urban income grew slower than rural during this period. Since our cities are at least three times more productive than their rural counterparts, deceleration in their productivity growth does not augur well for overall growth. Poor growth performance in urban areas could be directly related to the quality of life our cities offer. For example, though 95% of municipal waste is collected, only 50% is treated. Water availability is about 115 lpcd (litre per capita per day) in big cities compared to the benchmark of 135-150 lpcd.

And the price-to-income ratio (PTI)—the price to buy a 950 sq. feet apartment by the median earning household—is 11 in our cities as opposed to the affordability benchmark of 5. Sub-optimal service delivery is due to many factors, with lack of funds being one of them. Indian cities spend about a quarter on urban infrastructure of what needs to be spent. The Centre's proposal to set up an Urban Challenge Fund of ₹1 lakh crore is an interesting idea to push urban infrastructure build-out. The proposed Fund should incorporate elements of expenditure efficiency, transparent planning, and stable governance to move the needle on service delivery.

Question 4:
Which urban service challenge is specifically mentioned in the passage?

a) Traffic congestion is the primary concern in Indian metros.
b) Water supply in big cities is below the benchmark level.
c) Urban crime rates have risen sharply in the last decade.
d) Electricity outages in major cities have increased by 50%.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
Why has urban development been identified as a key pillar in the Union Budget 2025?

a) Indian urban areas have the lowest per capita productivity in the world.
b) Rural areas are growing faster than urban areas, requiring a policy shift.
c) The urban share of GDP has stagnated, despite rising urban population.
d) The quality of life in cities has significantly declined, leading to mass migration.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question:

Precis writing:

Original Text: In recent years, the world has witnessed an exponential rise in the use of digital technologies, marking a fundamental shift in how people communicate, work, and interact with the world around them. Devices such as smartphones, laptops, and tablets have become integral to daily life, allowing individuals to stay connected, access information, and carry out tasks with unprecedented ease. Social media platforms, in particular, have revolutionized how people share information, form relationships, and express opinions. The proliferation of these technologies has undeniably brought numerous benefits, including greater convenience, new avenues for business growth, and enhanced educational opportunities for students and professionals alike. However, the rapid rise of digital technologies has also brought with it a series of challenges and concerns.

The constant connection to devices and social media has raised alarms about its impact on mental health, particularly regarding issues like addiction, anxiety, and the erosion of privacy. Studies have shown that excessive screen time can disrupt sleep patterns, contribute to feelings of isolation, and negatively affect attention spans. Furthermore, the rapid pace of technological advancements has led to a growing digital divide. While many individuals enjoy the benefits of digital innovation, there remains a significant portion of the global population that lacks access to the necessary resources, skills, or infrastructure to take advantage of these technologies. The digital divide is particularly evident in developing countries, where access to reliable internet and modern devices is often limited. This disparity has led to concerns about widening inequality, as those who are unable to engage with the digital world are increasingly left behind in terms of education, employment opportunities, and access to essential services. In light of these issues, there has been a growing call for governments, businesses, and educational institutions to invest in digital literacy programs. By improving access to digital tools and education, it is hoped that more people can fully participate in the digital revolution and bridge the gap between those who have access to technology and those who do not.

Precis: The rise of digital technologies, including smartphones, laptops, and social media platforms, has fundamentally transformed how people communicate, work, and access information. These advancements have brought benefits such as increased convenience, business opportunities, and enhanced education. However, concerns about mental health, such as addiction and privacy issues, have emerged due to constant device usage. Additionally, the rapid technological development has created a digital divide, especially in developing countries where access to technology is limited. This disparity has raised issues of inequality in education, employment, and access to services. To address this, there are calls for governments and businesses to invest in digital literacy programs to ensure broader participation in the digital age.

- **Write an email to an organization requesting a collaboration opportunity.**

To:.....@gmail.com
Subject: Request for Collaboration Opportunity

Dear [Recipient's Name],

I hope this email finds you well. My name is [Your Name], and I represent [Your Organization's Name]. We specialize in [briefly describe your organization's services or products], and we have been following your organization’s work with great interest.

We believe that a collaboration between our organizations could be mutually beneficial, and we are eager to explore the possibility of working together.

Specifically, we are interested in [mention the type of collaboration you're seeking, such as joint events, co-branded initiatives, or sharing expertise].

We would love the opportunity to discuss how we could align our goals and create a partnership that adds value to both organizations. Please let us know a convenient time for a meeting or a call to further explore this opportunity.

Thank you for considering this request. We look forward to the possibility of collaborating with your team.

Best regards,
[Your Full Name]
[Your Job Title]
[Your Organization's Name]

Match the column

1. Haste makes waste	A. hear news of something secret
2. Get wind of something	B. small things of different types
3. Shape up or ship out	C. the hottest day of the summer season
4. Dog days of summer	D. work better or leave
5. Bits and Pieces	E. rushing through something can lead to mistakes

Answer:

1-e

2-a

3-d

4-c

5-b

Vocabulary

1. Exorbitant:
2. Impunity:
3. Renege:
4. Deplorable:
5. Insurmountable:
6. Exacerbate:
7. Impediment:
8. Unprecedented:
9. Utterance:
10. Ruinous:

RC ANS

1.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage suggests that India should introduce incentives to encourage fishermen to adopt sustainable fishing practices, as shifting away from bottom trawling will take time.

Reference:

"New Delhi must introduce incentives to encourage Palk Bay fishermen to move away from trawling."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – The passage does not advocate increased naval patrolling.

c) Incorrect – Harsher penalties could escalate tensions rather than solve the issue.

d) Incorrect – The passage does not suggest involving international organizations.

2.

Ans: a

Explanation:

The passage notes that the last meeting between Indian and Sri Lankan fishermen was in 2016, and despite the issue being raised in diplomatic meetings, the Sri Lankan government has not shown willingness to negotiate.

Reference:

"Indian fishermen have repeatedly sought a fresh round of talks with their Sri Lankan counterparts, with the last such meeting having taken place in November 2016... However, the Anura Kumara Dissanayake-led Sri Lankan government appears reluctant to negotiate."

Why other options are incorrect?

b) Incorrect – The passage mentions naval actions, but not that diplomacy is impossible.

c) Incorrect – The Indian government is actively seeking resolutions.

d) Incorrect – The passage does not suggest that India is prioritizing trade over this issue.

3.

Ans: d

Explanation:

The passage states that while in the past, detained Indian fishermen were quickly released, recent years have seen a rise in convictions, prison sentences, and hefty fines.

Reference:

"Unlike in the past, when they were quickly released, recent years have seen rising convictions for violations of the International Maritime Boundary Line (IMBL) and unlawful fishing."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – The passage mentions impounded boats, but not permanent confiscation.

b) Incorrect – Sri Lanka has become stricter, not more lenient.

c) Incorrect – Life imprisonment is not mentioned as a consequence.

4.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage states that water availability in Indian cities is 115 litres per capita per day (lpcd), which is below the benchmark of 135-150 lpcd. This indicates a gap in urban service delivery.

Reference:

"Water availability is about 115 lpcd in big cities compared to the benchmark of 135-150 lpcd."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – Traffic congestion is not identified as a primary issue here.

c) Incorrect – No mention of rising urban crime rates.

d) Incorrect – Electricity outages are not discussed in the passage.

5.

Ans: c

Explanation:

The passage highlights that urban areas have contributed 52-55% to GDP since 2000, even though the urban population has increased. This stagnation in urban GDP suggests slower per capita income growth in cities, which could negatively impact overall economic progress.

Reference:

"The urban share of GDP has remained stagnant between 52-55% from 2000-2020. Given that the urban share of the population has continued to increase during this period, this implies that per capita urban income grew slower than rural during this period."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – Indian urban productivity is higher than rural, not the lowest globally.

b) Incorrect – The passage does not state that rural areas are growing faster.

d) Incorrect – The passage discusses service delivery issues, not mass migration.

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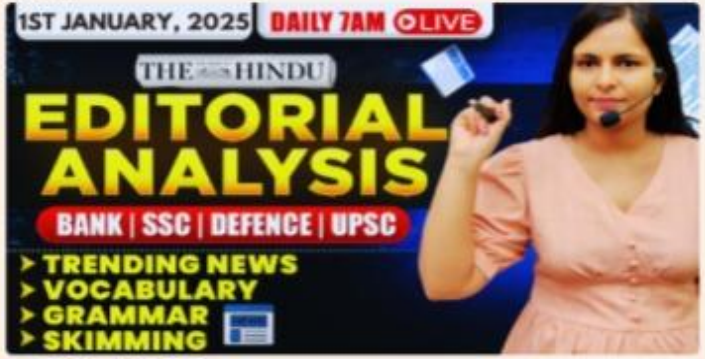

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Perfection Class: Debunking English Grammar Myths I Perfection I

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